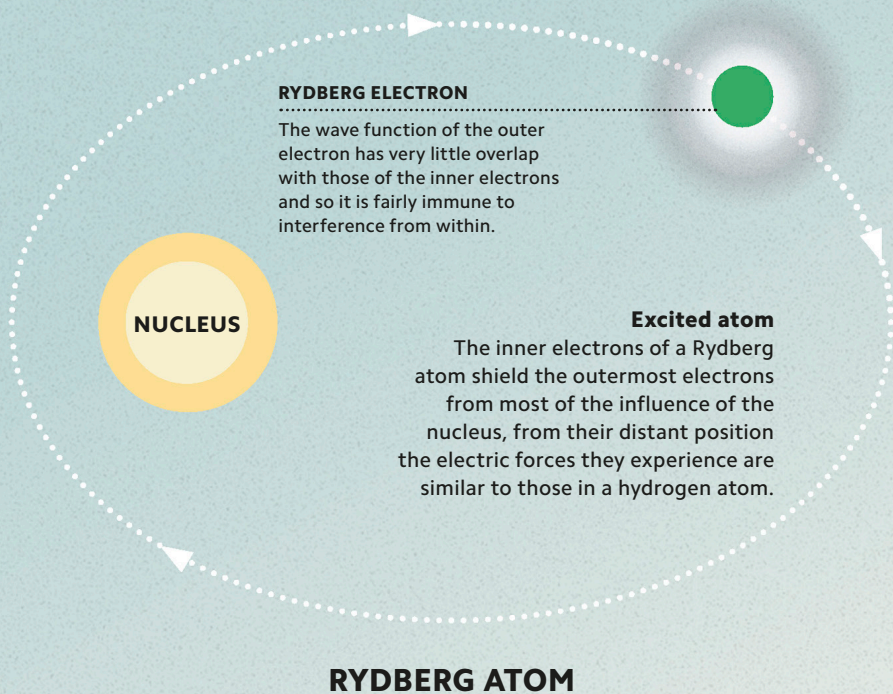




UNUSUAL ORBITS

Rydberg atoms are a form of matter in which at least one of an atom's electrons is boosted into a large orbit with a very high "principal quantum number." The great distance between the electron and the atom's inner core produces curious effects. Some properties of Rydberg atoms mirror those of hydrogen, but the atom's loose grip on the outer electron means it is easily ionized, and highly sensitive to electric and magnetic fields.